

school in Devon, and later gained a scholarship to Fettes College in Edinburgh.

This was, however, no place for a sensitive boy like Michael, who in 1920 admitted he had formed a romantic relationship with another boy, and was transferred to Stamford School in Lincolnshire, which had a reputation for musical education. Here he began to flourish—but as his confidence improved, he became outspoken in his left-leaning and atheistic views and was asked to leave in 1922.



**FETTES COLLEGE, EDINBURGH**

Tippett was a boarder at the school from 1918 to 1920—he was a member of the choir and also studied piano and the pipe organ. The school's grandiose main building, c. 1870, is shown here.

“ **Music** is a **performance** and **needs** the